



Crazy resolutions
Hasselblad introduces the 50 million pixel H3DII-50MS

Media centre gadgets
Viewsonic VPD500 is a five inch multimedia player and comes with 8 GB onboard memory

Contact

Western Digital

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Price: Rs. 10,500

Specifications

Ports: HDMI, Component, Composite A/V, Ethernet, 2xUSB 2.0; **Dimensions:**

125.5x100x40 mm;

Weight: 303 g

RATINGS

Features	8.5
Performance	6.5
Build Quality	7
Value	7
Overall	7.5



WD TV Live

Coming to a network near you

Western Digital's WD TV Live is an old player with an added network functionality. You can connect it to the display using HDMI, Component or Composite.

WD hasn't fiddled around too much with the interface of the player either. That means it's still as user friendly as it was. We quickly updated the firmware over the internet. The interface is quick but

we faced some slowdown after playing some HD clips over the network. This happened pretty often. A reboot fixes everything though.

The video playback performance is great – there is no framing whatsoever on 720p and 1080p content. DTS audio decoding is supported now. YouTube videos can be accessed as well. It even supports Flickr and streaming audio.

All in all, it's still a great HD player. There are a few performance bugs that we hope will be fixed in future firmware upgrades. The price is a little more than the older WD TV but so it's still pretty good value for money.

ZOTAC MAG

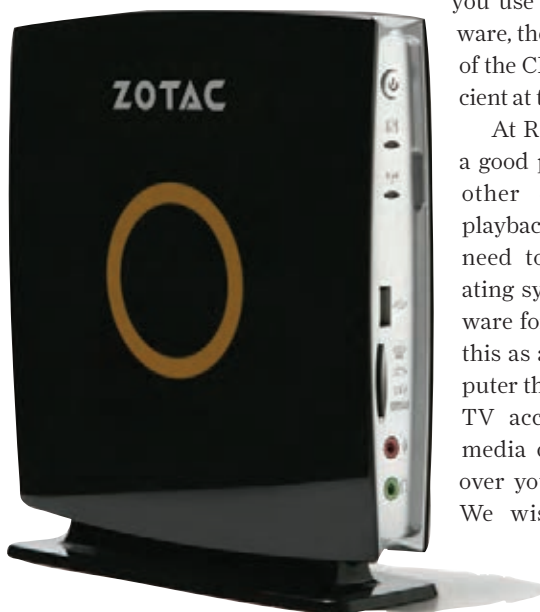
An ideal HTPC solution

We're testing a lot of LCDs and we are very aware of the lack of media playback devices for them. Building a HTPC can be a little annoying when you're looking for the right chassis and other components. ZOTAC's MAG is their first PC that is perfect for such needs.

The desktop comes with just the PC – it's compact, designed well and looks pretty. It runs an Intel Atom processor with NVIDIA's Ion platform. There's a 160 GB laptop hard drive in it and even WiFi 802.11n connectivity.

The scores from the benchmarks aren't extraordinary either – graphics performance is decent. Doom 3 can run at

an average framerate of 27.4 fps on 800 x 600 at medium detail and PCMark05's overall score is 2447. The case gets pretty hot while running intensive applications.



Being an Ion based platform isn't enough to run HD – you need to configure some of your software properly. Once that's done, 1080p is a breeze. That said, it's perfect as a HTPC. If you use heavy HTPC software, the processing power of the CPU itself isn't sufficient at times.

At Rs. 17,500, it will be a good purchase over any other dedicated media playback device. You only need to setup the operating system and the software for it. Ideally, we see this as a full fledged computer that sits next to your TV accessing streaming media content wirelessly over your home network. We wish it came with bundled wireless keyboard and mouse though.

Contact

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Price: Rs. 17,500

Configuration

Intel Atom 330 (1.6 GHz), integrated GeForce 9400M, 2 GB DDR2 memory, 160 GB hard drive, eSATA support, memory card reader, Gigabit network. 802.11 b/g/n support

RATINGS

Features	7.5
Performance	7
Build quality	7
Value for money ...	6.5
Overall	7